Answers and talk notes

Math is Finding Patterns

What your student is learning

Tonight we take a pattern that grows by the same amount every time and use it to predict something far in the future — how long a baby whale takes to reach full length.

Answers

Ask your student to explain before you look.

1. **A.** 6. 3 months with 2 pounds each is 3 × 2 = 6 pounds.
2. **C.** 18 cm. 4 weeks of growth is 4 × 2 = 8 cm, and 10 + 8 = 18 cm.
3. **D.** 6 m. 10 − 4 = 6 m is left to grow.
4. **B.** 8. 40 ÷ 5 = 8 steps.
5. **A.** 300. 1 meter is 100 centimeters, so 3 meters is 3 × 100 = 300 centimeters.

Talk about it

How much is left to grow, and how many steps of the same size does it take?

Home mission

A different situation: hold a ruler. Pretend a seedling is 5 cm tall and grows 2 cm each day. Ask your student how many days until it is 15 cm tall. Say first how much growth is left.

When they are stuck, ask

- How much does it change in one step? And how many steps do we need?
- Are both numbers in the same unit right now?
- Where does it start? Does it start at zero, or somewhere already?

Try not to say

- Just divide the big number by the small number.
- Units are just labels, ignore them.
- Count it out one day at a time, that is safest.